

Itemized equipment for a single 40-ft container gourmet-mushroom operation (Fun Guy Fungi), grouped by production zone and scoped to remain within the local VR&E approval threshold (*reported at ~\$25,000; to confirm with counselor*). Ranges are industry-baseline figures to be replaced by VBOC-sourced quotes; VR&E requires pre-approval on actual quotes before any purchase.

Category	Estimated range
Substrate & sterilization	\$2,500 – \$6,300
Lab / inoculation (clean zone)	\$650 – \$2,900
Incubation	\$800 – \$2,500
Fruiting chamber (climate control)	\$2,950 – \$10,000
Cold storage & packaging	\$700 – \$3,800
Monitoring & controls	\$300 – \$1,200
Initial inventory (spawn, substrate, consumables)	\$650 – \$1,800
Equipment total	~\$8,550 – \$28,500

Moderate build target: ~\$14,000 – \$22,000 — a mostly-new-with-some-used package that stays within the local-approval threshold. The lean end assumes DIY/steam pasteurization and hardware-store or used gear; the high end assumes new, more-automated equipment.

What each category includes

Substrate & sterilization: steam sterilizer / pressure vessel, impulse bag sealer, autoclavable grow bags.

Lab / inoculation: laminar flow hood (HEPA), still-air box, sanitation supplies.

Incubation: metal shelving/racking, temperature control and monitoring.

Fruiting chamber: HVAC (AC + heat), ultrasonic humidifier + hygostat controller, fresh-air-exchange fans + ducting + CO₂ sensor, waterproof LED lighting, fruiting shelving.

Cold storage & packaging: small cold storage / reach-in, scale, packaging, labels.

Monitoring & controls: digital environmental sensors and controllers (temp / humidity / CO₂).

Initial inventory: starter spawn / cultures, first-run substrate materials, consumables (alcohol, gloves, filters).

Facility / container (separate — counselor question)

A used 40-ft high-cube container (~\$3,000 – \$6,000) plus insulation and electrical fit-out (~\$3,000 – \$8,000) is **listed separately** because a container sits between “equipment” and “facility.” Open question for the counselor: does VR&E treat the container as fundable equipment, or is it self-funded? Keeping it separate protects the under-threshold equipment ask.

Phase-2 expansion (not part of this request): a second container, funded from business strength (reinvested revenue or SBA / veteran lending) once Phase 1 is proven — the documented path to the two-container goal without enlarging the initial ask.

Sources: container-farm industry data (Miracle, Satrise, CleanTec); Northstar Financial (2026); GroCycle / Out Grow / FarmstandApp equipment guides. Ranges are estimates to be finalized with VBOC-sourced quotes; VR&E pre-approval required before purchase.